

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

Now it's time to think about the new habits that you'd like to put in place. These are the healthy things that you want to introduce in order to make looking after your financial wellbeing easier, and I've set out five suggested areas to work on later in this section.

First, can you think of ways to make them **obvious**? How about keeping your budget spreadsheet in a folder on your phone, or using an app-based savings account? Clear talks about designing your environment to make the positive choices the easiest ones – is this something you can look at doing spatially or digitally?

The next thing to think about is making your new habits **attractive**. This is where creating rituals, or, as Clear terms it, 'temptation bundling' comes in. When I talk about incorporating budgeting or other money management techniques into your self-care by coupling them with other, more appealing activities, I often see a little metaphorical light bulb flicker on. I'd realized fairly early in my own journey with money that if I paired updating my budget with something that I really enjoy doing, like having a long bath, or a glass of wine, or splitting a tub of Haagen Dazs with my husband, I found it much easier to do consistently. I also found that if I made this into a little Sunday-night ritual, and did it at roughly the same time each week, the knock-on effect to my wellbeing for the following week was fairly remarkable. The act of checking in with myself and creating moments of enjoyment around something that had previously terrified me gave me